COMPLIANCE RAJ

ENDING THE RED TAPE

INDIA MUST TRIM THE REGULATORY CHOLESTEROL THAT STIFLES ITS INDUSTRY AND USHER IN GENUINE EASE OF DOING BUSINESS TO MAKE INDIAN ENTERPRISES MORE COMPETITIVE AND CAPABLE OF WITHSTANDING ANY TRADE UPHEAVAL

By **M.G. ARUN & SONAL KHETARPAL**

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS / AI**

As **Donald Trump was turning the world upside down** with his tariffs, like a child playing Demolition Derby on a video game, the world was left scrambling to cope with the consequences of the American president's trigger-happy trade policies. Prime Minister Narendra Modi's pre-emptive trip to the United States did little to shield India from the Trumpian blitzkrieg. Though India was spared the worst and Trump himself hit a 90-day pause button on April 9, New Delhi had already been mulling ways to strengthen Indian industry in anticipation of Trump's trade war. High on the list was the urgent need to remove the regulatory cholesterol clogging the arteries of India's economic growth. The unanimous consensus among experts: the Compliance Raj must go.

The first hint perhaps came in the Economic Survey released 11 days after Trump was sworn in. Chief Economic Advisor V. Anantha Nageswaran mentioned the need for deregulation and reforms in land, labour and capital to free